

Word family: **distribution / distributions / distribute / distributed / distributor**

Base word: distribution

Part of speech: mainly **noun**

Related forms:

* **distribution** (n.) — 分配；分發；分布；配送；分銷

* **distribute** (v.) — 分配；分發；分布；配送；發行

* **distributed** (adj./participle) — 分散的；已分配的；分布式的

* **distributor** (n.) — 分銷商；經銷商；分配 / 配送者

* **redistribute** (v.) — 重新分配

* **redistribution** (n.) — 再分配；重新分配

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **distribution of effort**

* **unequal distribution**

* **even distribution**

* **distribution of work**

* **income distribution**

* **wealth distribution**

* **population distribution**

* **geographical distribution**

* **frequency distribution**

* **normal distribution**

* **probability distribution**

* **distribution network**

* **distribution centre**

* **distribution channel**

* **food distribution**

* **electricity distribution**

* **film distribution**

* **distribute tasks**

* **distribute resources**

* **widely distributed**

* **distributed system**

* **redistribution of wealth**

Meaning in this passage

> One major challenge of group work is the unequal **distribution of effort**.

Here, **distribution** means:

the way effort is divided or shared among different team members — 分配；分布

Some employees do much more work than others, so the total effort is not shared evenly.

中文翻譯：

團隊合作其中一個主要問題，就是努力和工作量的**分配不均**。

So here:

distribution of effort = 團隊中的工作和努力如何分配到不同成員身上

1. **distribution (分配；分派) — 分配；分派**

This is the exact sense used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> One major challenge is the unequal **distribution of effort**.

其中一個主要問題就是努力的**分配不均**。

Practice 2

> A fair **distribution of work** can reduce resentment.

公平的**工作分配**可以減少不滿。

Practice 3

> The manager reviewed the **distribution of responsibilities** across the team.

經理檢視了團隊內各項責任的**分配情況**。

MCQ-ready definition:

distribution = 某些工作、資源、責任等如何分給不同的人或群體

2. **distribution of effort — 努力 / 付出的分配**

Practice 1

> The **distribution of effort** was clearly unequal.

大家的**付出分配**明顯不均。

Practice 2

> Better role allocation can improve the **distribution of effort**.

更好的角色分配可以改善團隊的**付出分布**。

MCQ-ready definition:

distribution of effort = 不同成員分別投入多少努力的整體分配情況

3. **distribution of work / workload** — 工作 / 工作量分配

Practice 1

> The **distribution of work** should be fair.

工作分配應該公平。

Practice 2

> Poor **distribution of workload** left two employees overwhelmed.

工作量**分配不當**令兩名員工不勝負荷。

MCQ-ready definition:

distribution of work = 工作如何在不同人之間分派

4. **unequal / uneven distribution** — 分配不均；分布不均

Practice 1

> The team suffered from an **unequal distribution of responsibilities**.

團隊因責任**分配不均**而出現問題。

Practice 2

> There is an **uneven distribution of resources** between departments.

不同部門之間的資源**分配並不平均**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****unequal/uneven distribution = 某物在不同人或地方之間的份量明顯不相等****

5. ****fair / equal distribution — 公平 / 平均分配****

Practice 1

> Workers expect a ****fair distribution of tasks****.

員工期望任務得到****公平分配****。

Practice 2

> Equal distribution is not always the same as fair distribution.

****平均分配**不一定等於****公平分配****。**

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****fair/equal distribution = 把某物以公平或相等方式分給不同對象****

6. ****distribute something among / between people — 在人們之間分配某物****

A major verb pattern.

Practice 1

> The manager ****distributed the tasks among the team members****.

經理把任務****分配給不同組員****。

Practice 2

> The work was ****distributed between the two departments****.

工作被****分配到兩個部門****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****distribute X among/between people = 把 X 分給多個人或群體****

7. **distribute resources — 分配資源**

Practice 1

> Managers need to **distribute resources carefully**.

管理人員需要小心**分配資源**。

Practice 2

> The budget was **distributed across several projects**.

預算被**分配到數個項目**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****distribute resources = 把金錢、人手、物資等分配到不同用途或對象****

8. **distribution (分發 ; 派發) — 分發 ; 派送**

A second major branch.

Practice 1

> Volunteers helped with the **distribution of food**.

義工協助**派發食物**。

Practice 2

> The organisation manages the **distribution of emergency supplies**.

機構負責**分發緊急物資**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****distribution = 把物品送到或派給多個人、地方或機構的過程****

9. **food / aid distribution — 食物 / 援助物資派發**

Practice 1

> The centre organised **food distribution** for local families.

中心為本地家庭安排**食物派發**。

Practice 2

> The storm interrupted the **distribution of aid**.

暴風影響了**援助物資的派發**。

MCQ-ready definition:

food/aid distribution = 把食物或援助物資送交有需要人士的過程

10. **distribute leaflets / documents / materials — 派發傳單 / 文件 / 物料**

Practice 1

> Staff **distributed the documents** before the meeting.

員工在會議前**派發文件**。

Practice 2

> Volunteers **distributed leaflets** outside the station.

義工在車站外**派發傳單**。

MCQ-ready definition:

distribute X = 把多份 X 派給多個人

11. **distribution (商品配送 ; 物流) — 配送 ; 物流分發**

A major business sense.

Practice 1

> The company has an efficient **distribution network**.

公司擁有高效的**配送網絡**。

Practice 2

> The products are stored before **distribution**.

產品在**配送**前會先被儲存。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****distribution = 把商品從生產者或倉庫運送到商店、顧客或其他銷售點的過程****

12. ****distribution network — 配送網絡；分銷網絡****

Practice 1

> The company expanded its ****distribution network****.

公司擴大了****配送 / 分銷網絡****。

Practice 2

> A strong ****distribution network**** helps products reach customers quickly.

完善的****配送網絡****有助產品快速送到顧客手上。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****distribution network = 負責把商品送往不同地區、商店或顧客的一整套物流渠道****

13. ****distribution centre — 配送中心****

Practice 1

> The goods are sent to a regional ****distribution centre****.

貨物被送往地區****配送中心****。

Practice 2

> The company opened a new ****distribution centre****.

公司開設了一個新的****配送中心****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****distribution centre = 儲存、整理並把貨物配送到不同地點的物流設施****

14. **distribution channel — 分銷渠道**

Practice 1

> Online sales became an important **distribution channel**.

網上銷售成為一條重要的**分銷渠道**。

Practice 2

> The company uses several **distribution channels**.

公司使用數種不同的**分銷渠道**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****distribution channel = 商品從生產者到顧客所經過的銷售或配送途徑****

15. **distributor — 分銷商；經銷商**

Practice 1

> The manufacturer sells through local **distributors**.

製造商透過本地**分銷商**銷售產品。

Practice 2

> They became the official **distributor** for the brand.

他們成為該品牌的官方**經銷商**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****distributor = 從生產者取得商品，再把商品供應給零售商或顧客的公司或機構****

16. **distribution (電影 / 媒體發行) — 發行**

A distinct media/business branch.

Practice 1

> The studio handles international film **distribution**.

這間工作室負責電影的國際**發行**。

Practice 2

> The film secured a **distribution deal**.

這部電影取得了一份**發行協議**。

MCQ-ready definition:

distribution = 把電影、音樂或其他媒體作品提供給戲院、平台或市場的商業發行過程

17. **film distributor — 電影發行商**

Practice 1

> The **distributor** released the film internationally.

發行商把電影推向國際市場。

Practice 2

> Independent filmmakers often need to find a **distributor**.

獨立電影製作人通常需要尋找**發行商**。

MCQ-ready definition:

film distributor = 負責把電影推向戲院、平台和市場的公司

18. **distribution (分布) — 分布 ; 分佈情況**

A major spatial/statistical sense.

Practice 1

> The map shows the **distribution of the population**.

地圖顯示人口的**分布情況**。

Practice 2

> Rainfall has an uneven **distribution** across the region.

該地區的降雨量**分布不均**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****distribution = 某些人、物或現象在不同地方或範圍內如何散布****

19. ****population distribution — 人口分布****

Practice 1

> Geography affects ****population distribution****.

地理因素會影響****人口分布****。

Practice 2

> The map illustrates the country's ****population distribution****.

地圖顯示該國的****人口分布****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****population distribution = 人口在不同地區之間的分布模式****

20. ****geographical distribution — 地理分布****

Practice 1

> Researchers studied the ****geographical distribution**** of the species.

研究人員研究該物種的****地理分布****。

Practice 2

> The disease has a wide ****geographical distribution****.

這種疾病的****地理分布****很廣。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****geographical distribution = 某物在不同地理區域出現的位置和範圍****

21. ****widely distributed — 廣泛分布****

Practice 1

> The species is **widely distributed** across Asia.

這個物種在亞洲**廣泛分布**。

Practice 2

> Offices are **distributed across several cities**.

辦公室**分布在數个城市**。

MCQ-ready definition:

distributed across X = 散布於 X 的不同部分

22. **distribution (統計：分布) — 統計分布；機率分布**

A major technical sense.

Practice 1

> The data follow a normal **distribution**.

數據呈**常態分布**。

Practice 2

> The graph shows the **distribution of test scores**.

圖表顯示考試分數的**分布**。

MCQ-ready definition:

distribution = 在統計學中，數值在不同可能值或範圍中的分布方式

23. **frequency distribution — 次數分布；頻數分布**

Practice 1

> The table shows the **frequency distribution** of the scores.

表格顯示分數的**頻數分布**。

Practice 2

> A **frequency distribution** summarizes how often each value occurs.

頻數分布總結每個數值出現多少次。

MCQ-ready definition:

frequency distribution = 顯示不同數值或區間分別出現多少次的統計表示

24. **normal distribution** — 常態分布；正態分布

Practice 1

> The measurements roughly follow a **normal distribution**.

測量結果大致呈**常態分布**。

Practice 2

> A **normal distribution** has a characteristic bell-shaped curve.

常態分布具有典型的鐘形曲線。

MCQ-ready definition:

normal distribution = 一種對稱、中央值附近數據最多的鐘形機率分布

25. **probability distribution** — 機率分布

Practice 1

> The model uses a **probability distribution**.

模型使用一種**機率分布**。

Practice 2

> A **probability distribution** assigns probabilities to possible outcomes.

機率分布為不同可能結果分配機率。

MCQ-ready definition:

****probability distribution = 描述不同可能結果分別有多大機率發生的數學分布****

26. ****distribution (收入 / 財富分配) — 收入 / 財富分配****

Practice 1

> The report examines income ****distribution****.

報告研究收入****分配情況****。

Practice 2

> The country has a highly unequal ****distribution of wealth****.

這個國家的財富****分配非常不均****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****distribution of income/wealth = 收入或財富如何分布在不同人口群體之間****

27. ****income distribution — 收入分配****

Practice 1

> Tax policy can affect ****income distribution****.

稅務政策可以影響****收入分配****。

Practice 2

> The study compared ****income distribution**** across regions.

研究比較不同地區的****收入分布情況****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****income distribution = 社會中不同個人或群體所得收入的分布情況****

28. ****redistribute — 重新分配****

Practice 1

> The manager **redistributed** the workload.

經理**重新分配**了工作量。

Practice 2

> Resources were **redistributed** across departments.

資源被**重新分配**到不同部門。

MCQ-ready definition:

redistribute = 把已經分配好的東西重新以另一種方式分配

29. **redistribution** — 再分配；重新分配

Practice 1

> The **redistribution** of tasks made the workload fairer.

任務的**重新分配**令工作量更公平。

Practice 2

> The policy led to a **redistribution** of resources.

該政策帶來資源的**再分配**。

MCQ-ready definition:

redistribution = 把資源、工作、收入等重新分配的過程

30. **distributed system / distributed computing** — 分布式系統 / 分散式運算

A major computing sense.

Practice 1

> The service runs on a **distributed system**.

這項服務在一個**分布式系統**上運行。

Practice 2

> **Distributed computing** uses multiple connected computers.

分布式運算使用多部互相連接的電腦共同處理工作。

MCQ-ready definition:

distributed system = 功能或運算被分散到多部互相連接的電腦，而不是集中在單一裝置上的系統

31. **distributed team** — 分散式團隊；異地團隊

A common modern workplace extension.

Practice 1

> Managing a **distributed team** requires clear communication.

管理**分散在不同地點的團隊**需要清楚溝通。

Practice 2

> The company has a globally **distributed workforce**.

公司的人手**分布在世界各地**。

MCQ-ready definition:

distributed team = 成員位於不同地點、通常透過數碼工具合作的團隊

32. **electricity / power distribution** — 電力配送；配電

Practice 1

> The storm damaged the electricity **distribution network**.

暴風破壞了**配電網絡**。

Practice 2

> Power **distribution** is managed through local networks.

電力透過本地網絡進行**配送 / 配電**。

MCQ-ready definition:

****electricity distribution = 把電力從輸電系統送到家庭、企業等最終使用者的過程****

Important distinction 1: ****distribution vs allocation****

Very important for your passage.

****distribution****

focuses on ****how something is spread or divided**** among recipients.

****allocation****

focuses on the decision to ****assign a specific share/resource for a purpose****.

> distribution of effort

> 努力如何分布

> allocation of tasks

> 任務如何被分配

They overlap, but ****allocation**** often emphasizes deliberate planning.

Important distinction 2: ****distribution vs division****

****division****

act of splitting something into parts.

****distribution****

what happens to those parts afterward—who or where they go to.

> divide the workload into five tasks

> 把工作拆成五項

> distribute the tasks among five employees

> 把五項工作分派給員工

Important distinction 3: ****distribution vs sharing****

sharing

often emphasizes people jointly having or using something.

distribution

more neutral/formal and often systematic.

- > share responsibility

- > 共同承擔責任

- > distribution of responsibility

- > 責任分配情況

Important distinction 4: **distribution vs delivery**

delivery

bringing a particular item to its destination.

distribution

the broader system/process of sending many goods to many destinations.

- > delivery to one customer

- > 送貨給一名顧客

- > nationwide distribution network

- > 全國配送網絡

Important distinction 5: **distribution vs logistics**

distribution

specifically moving goods outward to markets/customers.

logistics

broader management of:

- * storage,

- * transport,

- * inventory,
- * supply flows.

Distribution is often one part of logistics.

Important distinction 6: ****distribution vs supply****

****supply****

make goods/resources available.

****distribution****

determine or manage where those goods/resources go.

- > water supply
- > 供水

- > water distribution network
- > 配水網絡

Important distinction 7: ****distribute vs hand out****

****distribute****

neutral/formal and broad.

****hand out****

informal and usually physically give items to people.

- > distribute emergency supplies
- > 分發緊急物資

- > hand out worksheets
- > 派工作紙

Important distinction 8: ****distribute vs spread****

****distribute****

often deliberate:

> distribute resources.

spread

often movement outward, potentially naturally:

> disease spreads.

But in location descriptions:

> species are distributed across the region

is natural and does not imply anyone deliberately distributed them.

Important distinction 9: **distribution = allocation vs distribution = spatial pattern**

Compare:

> distribution of tasks

> 任務**分配**

> distribution of population

> 人口**分布**

The first involves dividing something among people.

The second describes where something is located.

This is a genuine learner-relevant polysemy split.

Important distinction 10: **distribution = physical goods vs statistical data**

Logistics:

> distribution of products

> 商品配送

Statistics:

> distribution of scores

> 分數分布

Same noun, very different domains.

Important distinction 11: **normal distribution**

This does **not** mean:

> an ordinary way of distributing something.

It is a fixed mathematical/statistical term:

常態 / 正態分布

Important distinction 12: **distributor vs retailer**

distributor

normally supplies goods onward to retailers, businesses, or regions.

retailer

sells directly to end consumers.

A company can sometimes perform both roles, but the functions differ.

Important distinction 13: **distributor vs supplier**

supplier

provides products/materials broadly.

distributor

specifically handles distribution into a market/channel.

A distributor is a type of supplier in many situations, but not every supplier is a distributor.

Important distinction 14: ****redistribution****

The prefix ****re-**** means:

****again / differently****

So:

> distribution

> 初次 / 現有分配

> redistribution

> 重新分配

This can apply to:

* workload,

* income,

* resources,

* seats,

* responsibilities.

Important distinction 15: ****distributed in computing****

A ****distributed system**** is not merely:

> a system that has been handed out to different people.

Here, ****distributed**** means:

****components or computing work are spread across multiple machines/nodes****

This is a distinct technical extension of the “spread across locations” sense.

Family-extension note

****Distribution**** has a strong semantic core:

****the way something is divided, spread, or delivered across multiple recipients, places, or values****

That branches into:

1. **allocation**

- * distribution of effort
- * distribution of workload

2. **physical handing out**

- * food distribution
- * distribute leaflets

3. **business/logistics**

- * distribution network
- * distributor

4. **media**

- * film distribution

5. **spatial spread**

- * population distribution
- * geographical distribution

6. **statistics**

- * frequency distribution
- * normal distribution
- * probability distribution

7. **economic distribution**

- * income distribution
- * wealth distribution

8. **redistribution**

- * redistribute workload/resources

9. **computing**

- * distributed system

10. **utilities**

* power distribution

For your passage, the exact branch is:

distribution = how the total effort is divided among individual team members

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
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distribution (allocation)	分配	divide among recipients
distribution of effort	努力 / 付出分配	teamwork
distribution of work	工作分配	workload
unequal distribution	分配不均	imbalance
fair distribution	公平分配	fair allocation
distribute tasks	分派任務	assign among people
distribute resources	分配資源	resource allocation
distribution (handing out)	分發；派發	give out
food distribution	食物派發	aid/supply
distribution (logistics)	配送；分銷	goods movement
distribution network	配送 / 分銷網絡	logistics
distribution centre	配送中心	logistics facility
distribution channel	分銷渠道	route to market
distributor	分銷商；經銷商	business intermediary
film distribution	電影發行	media
distribution (spatial)	分布	where things occur
population distribution	人口分布	geography
geographical distribution	地理分布	spatial spread
widely distributed	廣泛分布	broad spread
distribution (statistics)	統計分布	values
frequency distribution	頻數分布	statistics
normal distribution	常態 / 正態分布	statistics
probability distribution	機率分布	mathematics
income distribution	收入分配	economics
redistribute	重新分配	distribute again
redistribution	再分配	new allocation
distributed system	分布式系統	computing
distributed team	分散式 / 異地團隊	workplace
power distribution	配電	utilities

For your original sentence

> One major challenge of group work is the unequal **distribution of effort**.

Here:

distribution of effort = 團隊所需要的總工作和心力，究竟由哪些成員承擔、各人承擔多少

The paragraph immediately explains the imbalance:

> some employees **shoulder most of the burden**

> while others **contribute very little**

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 團隊合作其中一個主要問題，是成員之間的**付出分配不均**。

The cleanest contrast is:

> **division** = 把整體拆成幾部分

> **allocation** = 有計劃地把資源 / 任務分配用途

> **distribution** = **描述某物最終如何分布或分配在不同人 / 地方之間**

> **delivery** = 把實物送到目的地

For this passage, **distribution** focuses on the **pattern of who ends up carrying how much of the team's total effort**.